

First global high-speed broadband for the skies

US-based Honeywell Aerospace and Gogo, suppliers of in-flight connectivity systems to airlines, in collaboration with satellite giant Inmarsat, are now coming up with the 'first global high-speed broadband for the skies.' The Global Xpress (GX) Aviation network will enable passengers to surf the web as if they were in a coffee shop and will satisfy their craving for high-speed Wi-Fi on planes.

According to Briand Greer, president of Honeywell Aerospace Asia Pacific, "In-flight Wi-Fi could generate \$2.8 billion for the company alone over the next 20 years. Around 7-8 per cent of airlines currently offer wireless connection, but this number is expected to grow to 25 per cent by 2018."

In-flight Wi-Fi will now enable download speeds of up to 50 megabits per second, thanks to the advanced technology. "It will be like you are sitting at Starbucks with your smartphone, your computer and your iPad," Greer added.

Free voice calling without Internet

Engineers from M.S. Ramaiah Institute of Technology, Bengaluru have come up with 'FreeKall,' a new free voice-calling service that works without the need of any Internet connection. FreeKall will be free for all and offer voice calls to users on all mobile devices.

The free voice calling will, however, come at a price of its own: The service will incorporate advertisements between calls. All you have to do is dial the FreeKall number or give a missed call to it, and the service will call you back. Just enter the number of the person you want to connect, when prompted, and FreeKall will do the rest. Upon connecting, you can start



Free voice calling without Internet

talking for free. Users will hear an ad instead of a dialler tone when the call is being connected. Further, both the caller as well as the called person will have to pause their conversation at intervals of two minutes during which as well they will hear an ad.

Onyxphone, an ink phone made for reading

With massive technologies coming in the market, a major concern for a buyer is a phone's battery back-up. Onyx Midia has launched the OnyxPhone, a device that features a Rock-

chip processor and an energy-saving 10.9cm (4.3-inch) e-Ink screen, unlike the commonly used LCDs or OLEDs. This is a new-age solution to power consumption in phones.

Reportedly, the phone does not support the same colour and fast refresh speed, thus videos and gaming may not be a success. The OnyxPhone features a 1GHz Rockchip processor, 512MB RAM and an 1800mAh battery. The phone does not use a hybrid e-Ink or an LCD screen as in the Yotaphone. It is entirely an e-Ink device.

E-dogs to detect explosives

If IIT Bombay has its way, very soon our security personnel will bid adieu to traditional bomb-sniffing dogs and replace them with e-dogs. The prototype e-dog will be an ultra-sensitive low-cost explosive detector that could effectively detect an IED or RDX explosives in either of the three states of matter.

The e-dog will come with an e-nose comprising sensors made up of a nano-material called cantilever. Having much more stronger 'sniffing' powers than the olfactory powers of a real dog, the e-dog will be able to sense traces of RDX from a distance of 46cm, claim the developers.



OnyxPhone with e-Ink touchscreen